actions in Jammu and Kashmir to signal sensitivity to important Indian interests.

The reality, to which India–Russia relations are still in the process of adjusting, is the flux in the post–Cold War world order, with middle and major powers seeking to carve out political and economic space for themselves alongside the sole superpower. Both countries share the objective of a multipolar world, though their perceptions of their own roles in it vary. The strategies pursued by each reflect its perceptions of its geopolitical opportunities and challenges. Unlike during the Cold War years, therefore, their interests are not congruent. The common ground is opposition to a US–China G2 bipolarity.

This situation, of convergence not amounting to congruence, has been well analysed in the context of the India–US partnership by a task force on India–US relations, set up in 2015 by the US Council on Foreign Relations. Observing that the United States is more used to alliances, it suggested that this model would not suit the peculiar circumstances of the India–US partnership. It suggested that the United States should look at relations with India as a joint venture of mutual benefit to both partners, which would not preclude other partnerships of either party.[31] This could equally be the template for post–Cold War India–Russia relations. They have shared geopolitical, defence, economic, and energy interests in this "joint venture." Some of them will be impacted by other partnerships of India and Russia – the United States and China, in particular. Navigation through these conflicts of interest will require bilateral reconciliation but will also be dependent on external factors.

The dominant external influence will be that of the developing configuration of the triangle of relations, US–Russia–China. Writing in the US journal *Foreign Affairs* in 2016, a veteran Chinese diplomat wrote that relations